Optimization Concept Intake Guide

Create a business case to support your optimization concept

Utilizing our design thinking approach, a business case can be broken down into discrete steps. Use this guide to prepare your CRO ticket for submission.

EMPATHIZE

Purpose: The "Empathize" phase of work will help to clarify strategy and baseline performance and aid in discovery of issues or highlight potential opportunities.

Output: A problem or opportunity that is supported by data that can be evaluated as a potential test opportunity.

Things to consider in this phase:	*Use this section to document your findings.*
Overall business objectives Tip: Refer to your Digital OKRs and other known business objectives	*Work to understand Digital and team level goals and objectives at a high level.*
Page or flow level strategy Tip: Consult with team leads or team members for input into parallel strategies	*Work to understand the strategy of the space you are evaluating. Consider that multiple strategies may overlap in the same space and provide context, where possible.*
Traffic Tip: Consult with your support analyst or your Committee Lead for help in identifying the right analytics approach	*How much traffic does your page or flow get, and what is the source of traffic? Are there prominent audiences or segments that apply?*
Baselines Tip: Align your measurement strategy with team and Digital scorecards whenever possible	*Learn your baseline metrics that influence your strategy in the space. Consider things like traffic, engagement, bounce or exit metrics, and progression or sales metrics.*
Evaluate	*Review your findings and compare objectives and strategies to performance metrics and baselines. Note gaps and consider new requirements (if any). The data you have collected will serve as the justification for a potential test concept that you can work to define.*

DEFINE

Purpose: The "Define" phase of work is where problems or opportunities are defined effectively into test concepts.

Output: A defined business problem or opportunity that is supported by data, well documented, contains an appropriate hypothesis, and has been generally assessed for alignment with standards and roadmaps.

Things to consider in this phase:	*Use this section to document your findings.*
Data	*What data do I already have that could inform and support my hypothesis?*
Hypothesis Tip: Leverage learnings from the Empathize phase of work to craft your hypothesis	*Craft your hypothesis:* ▪ *Identify the observed problem or opportunity.* ▪ *Identify the concept that will impact the observed problem or opportunity.* ▪ *Identify the impact that would represent success.*
Implementation	*Which Product team would implement your solution if you identify a "win"? Have you engaged them already?*
Standards Tip: Work with Committee Leads to connect to partners for alignment with standards	*What standards apply to the space you are working in? Consider UX, performance, or other standards.*

You are ready to submit a CRO Ticket!

Submitting Your Ticket:

Once you work through the Empathize and Define phases of work you are ready to submit a CRO ticket. There are a few key areas where clarity will ensure that your ticket passes through intake quickly and easily:

JIRA Field	*Input Tips*
Summary	*This should be a concise statement that clearly represents your business problem or opportunity and serves as a label for your request for CRO Program reporting.*
Description Tip: Include links to source of information/reporting	*This is where the information that your found during the Empathize and Define phases is summarized. Note whether the request is intended as an experiment or a content request. Detail supporting the business problem/opportunity, include your traffic and audience data, include any baselines that you have identified.*
Hypothesis	*Should be crafted in a similar manner as a science hypothesis. (This is what we see, we think that doing this will change that, because of this information)*
URL	*Provide complete clear URLs, for example, www.att.com/wireless instead of /wireless, or "wireless".*
Business Unit	*This is the business unit for the reporter*
Priority	*Provide justification within the Description for 911 or high*
Conversion Impact Areas	*Select all potential positive or negative impacts. This information is used to notify potentially cross impacted stakeholders – false positives are ok, but false negatives could cause delays.*
Primary Metric	*Select a metric that best indicates success; what metric will justify implementation of a winner if it is effectively impacted.*
Intake Review	*This field contains* ***default text*** *– retain it and add context where you are able:* ***Audience Definition:*** *Describe the technical audience that your campaign should impact* ***Variant Description:*** *If there is a clear comparative defined include a description of the control and variations. This element may not be defined yet – and that it OK.* ***Test/Flow (Repro) Steps:*** *Provide the steps to qualify for your scenario* ***Test Data/Credentials:*** *Provide any needed test credentials* ***Launch dependencies:*** *Note dependencies or risks*
Assigned Team Tip: Socialize concepts early	*This is the team that owns development for any potential winning variant and may differ from the Business Unit that requests the campaign.*

Submit!

What to expect next:

Submitted tickets in JIRA are reviewed daily with goal of ensuring basic test viability. Intake Leads will review ticket data and ensure that clear, complete business cases are presented. They may reach out with questions so follow your tickets closely and respond to comments.

Tickets are moved into *In Review Triage* where they are assigned to an Optimization Lead and reviewed for backlog approval. Work with your **Optimization Lead** to move your ticket forward into *In Definition* status in JIRA and finish out the Ideate Phase of the Design Thinking Process.

IDEATE

Purpose: The "Ideate" phase of work is where concepts are worked from submissions into viable test concepts that are added to testing backlogs.

Output: A quality test concept that is aligned with Digital strategies and is development ready.

Things to consider in this phase:	*Use this section to document your findings.*
Cross impacts Tip: Use Conversion Impact Area field to surface impacts	*What product, business, UX, or other cross impacts are there? Communicate widely to socialize your concept effectively to mitigate impacts or duplicate efforts.*
Solution/s Tip: Maintain alignment with known strategies and standards	*What recommended solutions could solve your identified problem or satisfy your opportunity? What functionality/foundations exist that support your solutions? (Example: Do we need new features, or do we need the ability to configure existing features?)*
Primary metric and data needs Tip: Consult with your support analyst, Optimization Lead or your Committee Lead for help in identifying the right primary metric	*What does success look like? What data point will justify implementation or determine success? Consult with your product team contacts to align on data needs.*
Test approach Tip: Work with your ticket Optimization Lead for test approach guidance	*What test approach provides the data perspective that you need?*
Intake Review	*This field contains* ***default text*** *– retain it and add context where needed:* ***Audience Definition:*** *Describe the technical audience that your campaign should impact* ***Variant Description:*** *Clearly describe the control state of the experience and any variations* ***Test/Flow (Repro) Steps:*** *Provide the steps to qualify for your scenario* ***Test Data/Credentials:*** *Provide any needed test credentials* ***Launch dependencies:*** *Note dependencies or risks*
Planning	*Document Target launch dates, offer start and end dates, clarify platform and site area details, and ensure that JIRA ticket information is complete. JIRA will be used to share information about launches widely, so be concise, clear, and complete in tickets at this phase. Ensure all details are locked in BEFORE tickets are moved into Development Ready.*